

1) Explain the concept of price. What are the factors determining the price of a product.

PRICE: Price is a source of revenue for the firm and it decides the health of the firm.

* Price also gives an image to the product.

PRICE DETERMINANTS:

i) Objective of business.

* The Fundamental Objective of a firm is to survive in the business and then thrive.

* The pricing strategy adopted by a firm is very much influenced by these factors.

* Thus, the basic guide to pricing is the firm's objectives.

(ii) Competition:

* To come out with a pricing policy that will be advantages to the firm, Managers requires a perfect understanding of the competitive environment in which the firm is placed.

(iii) product and promotional strategies:

* When a marketing strategy is formulated for a product, the four components are considered.

* Product itself

* pricing

* promotion activities and

* Distribution of products through channel

to the consumer

(iv) Nature of Price Sensitivity:

* We know that many factors contribute to

the increase of price sensitivity, but managers should not ignore the factors that minimize price sensitivity when designing pricing strategies.

(v) Influence of middleware.

* Middlemen are the ones who stock the finished product of the Manufacturer to sell it to the customers.

* They are also called the channel for distribution.

(vi) Routinization of price.

* This strategy of pricing relies on the tried and trusted pricing strategies which the organisation has followed all along.

*) Number of pricing decisions made

*) Speed of pricing decision.

*) Quality of available information

*) Competitive market.

(vii) Government Regulation :

* In order to safeguard the interests of the public the government acts on their belief to prevent the abuse of monopolistic power and collusion among business.

* The Government formulates policies and enacts law to control prices which may be against the interest of the public.

2) Explain the different types of ownership of a firm.

* A firm is a unit engaged in production of goods and services.

* The term firms includes all those enterprise which are related with the production not only of goods but also of services.

* The different types of ownerships of a firm are :

a) Sole proprietorship.

* Sole proprietorship is a form of business organisation which is owned, managed and controlled by a single individual.

Features :

* Single owner

* Full control over business

* Entire profit goes to owner

* owner bears all losses and risks.

* Simple to start and easy to manage.

b) Partnership :

* Partnership is a form of business organisation where two or more persons agree to carry on a business and share profits and losses.

Features :

* Minimum 2 persons

* Profit & Loss Sharing

* Joint Management

* Mutual agency

- * Partnership agreement

- * More capable than sole proprietorship.

(c) Joint Stock Company:

- * A Joint Stock Company is an organisation formed and registered under the Companies Act.

- * It has a separate legal entity apart from its owners.

Features:

- * Separate legal entity

- * Limited liability

- * Perpetual succession

- * Capital divided into shares

- * Managed by Board of Directors

- * Large capital

- * Legal formalities.

(d) Cooperative Society:

- * A co-operative Society is a voluntary association of persons who come together to promote their economic interests.

Feature:

- * Voluntary association

- * Service motive

- * Democratic management

- * Limited liability

- * Government support

- * Mutual help.

3) Explain the elements / Functions of Management.

MANAGEMENT:

* Management is a distinct process performed to determine and accomplish stated objectives by use of human being and other resources.

* The functions of management are

- *) Planning
- *) organizing
- *) staffing
- *) Directing
- *) controlling

*) planning:

* planning is an important function of management.

* planning is an activity by which managers analyze present conditions to determine ways of reaching a desired future state.

* planning is both an organizational necessity and a management responsibility.

* There are many different types of plans and planning

- *) Strategic planning
- *) Tactical planning
- *) operational planning.

Steps in planning process

Analyzing opportunities



Establishing objectives

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Determining the planning process

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Identifying Alternatives

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Evaluation

↓
Selection

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Implementation

↓
Review

*) organising :

* It involves developing an organizational structure and allocating human resources to ensure the accomplishment of objectives.

Steps in organizing process:

- * Identifying the work
- * Grouping the work
- * establishing formal reporting relationships
- * providing for measurements, evaluation & control
- * Delegating authority
- * Coordination.

*) Staffing :

* Staffing is the process by which managers select, train, promote and retire their subordinates.

* Staffing is a continuous process.

* Staffing involves

- * Manpower planning
- * Recruitment, selection & placement
- * Training & Development
- * Remuneration

* Directing:

* Directing is a process by which actual performance of subordinates is guided towards common goals of enterprise.

* It involves functions such as

- + Leadership
- + Communication
- * Motivation
- * Supervision

* Coordinating:

* Coordinating means achieving harmony of individual effort towards the accomplishment of company objectives.

* Controlling:

* Controlling is the process that measures current performance and guides it towards some predetermined goal. Controlling involves.

* It monitoring of programme activities to make sure that end objectives are being met.

* The Initiation of corrective actions on required to overcome problem.